

End of Year Report March 2020

Children's and Junior Section

It has been another great summer of athletics for the children's and junior section of the club. We had 26 children aged 7-14 register and compete over the season, along with 5 15-19 yr olds competing in the afternoon with the seniors. It was great to see our junior numbers increasing and some of last year's 14 year olds continue in the sport.

Training sessions have gone well, with 2 sessions being run on a Monday night focusing on field and track events, and one session on a Thursday night for running training only. With some of the athletes getting a bit older and needing more training, an extra session was set up for the 13+ yrs on a Tuesday night, to maximize their potential. This was seen to be beneficial for those who came along. A big thank-you to Paul Brouwers who ran these sessions when I was predisposed at college. I would also like to thank the parents and Ian that assisted with the Monday night training sessions, it made a big difference having extra pairs of hands to ensure the kids got more time to practice. I would also like to thank Denise for her continued support and great organizational skills, and a thank-you to Mike for his help at the track ensuring all the things that needed doing got done.

The season produced numerous good results at the bigger championship events, and as always athletes continued to improve throughout the season, mostly peaking and producing top results when it mattered most. The Colgate Games saw the club receive 2 gold, 5 silver, and 3 bronze medals. 27 P.B's and 10 S.B's were also recorded. Top moment was watching the 13 yr old medley team take out the gold medal in a very exciting race, well done to Aaron, Xanthe, Mya, Harrison and Pippa. The Canterbury Championships had Farai take out the overall gold medal for the 8yr old boys, a great achievement for his first year competing with the club. Individual placings were recorded, with 4 gold, 2 silver, and 6 bronze achieved, along with 30 P.B's and 4 S.B's.

The National championships were well represented this year by North Canterbury Junior athletes, 5 athletes took place in various events, all doing themselves and the club proud. Top result was Jess winning the Gold medal in the U18 High Jump with a new P.B., Hunter also found himself on the podium in the U18 Triple Jump, with a bronze medal. Just missing out on the podium was Ben, finishing in 4th place in the Shot Putt.

Unfortunately the season came to an abrupt end, but that was not without many of the club athletes being selected to represent Canterbury in the regional championships. Hopefully these athletes will get a chance to compete at a later date. Those selected were Mya, Xanthe and Aaron, with Will being a reserve.